

MATH 161A - Applied Probability & Statistics

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1. Skipped

2. Probability

2.1 Sample Spaces and Events

Probability

- Probability is used as a mathematical tool to understand or describe random phenomena, chance variation, and uncertainty.
- We will use probability as a tool to evaluate the reliability of our conclusions about the population when we only have sample information.
- Probability is used in a variety of fields including genetics, quality control, and finance.
- Probability is used as a model for situation for which outcomes occur randomly.
- Such situations are called **experiments**.
- Examples:
 - Toss a coin.
 - Roll a die.
 - Draw a card from a deck.

Vocabulary

- An action or process whose outcome is subject to uncertainty is called an **experiment**.
- The possible outcomes of an experiment are called **sample space**.
- An **event** is a specific outcome or a set of outcomes from an experiment.
- A **simple event** is an event that consists of a single outcome from sample space S .

Example What is the outcome of rolling an even (E), rolling greater than 3 (F), and rolling a 2 (G) on a 6-sided die?

$$S = 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6$$

$$E = 2, 4, 6$$

$$F = 4, 5, 6$$

$$G = 2$$

A Note on Venn Diagrams All Venn Diagrams in this course require a rectangle to represent the sample space. Events are represented by circles within the rectangle.

Operations

Set Operations

- $A \subseteq B$: A is a subset of B .
- $A \cap B$: the intersection of A and B (elements in both A and B).
- $A \cup B$: the union of A and B (elements in either A or B).
- A^c or A' : the complement of A (elements in S that are not in A).

Logical Operations

- A or B : $A \vee B$
- A xor B : $A \oplus B$
- A and B : $A \wedge B$
- not A : $\neg A$

Mutually Exclusive Events

- Events A and B are **mutually exclusive** if they cannot both occur at the same time.
 - In terms of set operations: $A \cap B = \emptyset$.
 - Example: Rolling a die and getting an even number (E) or an odd number (O) are mutually exclusive events.
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Identities

$$A \cup A' = S$$

$$A \cap A' = \emptyset$$

DeMorgan's Laws

$$(A \cup B)^c = A^c \cap B^c$$

$$(A \cap B)^c = A^c \cup B^c$$

$$\neg(A \vee B) = \neg A \wedge \neg B$$

$$\neg(A \wedge B) = \neg A \vee \neg B$$

2.2 Probability

Definition Probability is a function that maps the sample space S to $\mathbb{R}$. The sample space is the **domain** and the real numbers are the **codomain**.

Axioms of Probability

1. Non-negativity: For any event A , $P(A) \geq 0$.
2. Normalization: $P(S) = 1$, where S is the sample space.
3. Additivity: For any two mutually exclusive events A and B , $P(A_1 \cup A_2 \cup \dots \cup A_n) = \sum_{i=1}^n P(A_i)$.

$$P(\cup_{i=1}^n A_i) = \sum_{i=1}^n P(A_i)$$

Not axioms but useful observations

1. $P(A) < 1$ for any event A .
2. $P(A^c) = 1 - P(A)$.
3. $P(A \cap B) = P(A) + P(B) - P(A \cup B)$ for any two events A and B .

Proving Observations

Observation 1: $P(\emptyset) = 0$

$$\begin{aligned} P(\emptyset) &= 0 \\ \emptyset \cup S &= S \\ \emptyset \cap S &= \emptyset \\ P(\emptyset \cup S) &= P(S) \\ P(\emptyset) + P(S) &= P(S) \quad (\text{by axiom 3}) \end{aligned}$$

$\emptyset$ and S are mutually exclusive.
Therefore, $P(\emptyset) = 0$ by algebra.

Observation 2: $P(A^c) = 1 - P(A)$

$$S = A \cup A^c$$

$$\emptyset = A \cap A^c$$

$$P(A^c \cup A) = P(S)$$

$$P(A^c) + P(A) = P(S) \quad (\text{by axiom 3})$$

$$P(A^c) + P(A) = 1$$

$$P(A^c) = 1 - P(A)$$

Observation 3: $P(A \cup B) = P(A) + P(B)$ if $A \cap B = \emptyset$

$$P\left(\bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} A_i\right) = \sum_{i=1}^{\infty} P(A_i) \quad \text{for mutually exclusive } A_i$$

Let $A_1 = A$, $A_2 = B$, $A_3 = A_4 = \emptyset$

$$P(A \cup B \cup \emptyset \cup \emptyset) = P(A) + P(B) + 0$$

$$P(A \cup B) = P(A) + P(B) \quad (\text{by axiom 3})$$

Identities for the next proof

$$P(A) = P(A \cap B') + P(A \cap B)$$

$$P(B) = P(A' \cap B) + P(A \cap B)$$

$$P(A \cup B) = P(A \cap B') + P(A \cap B) + P(A' \cap B)$$

$$1 = P(A \cap B') + P(A \cap B) + P(A' \cap B) + P(A' \cap B')$$

Observation 4: $P(A \cup B) = P(A) + P(B) - P(A \cap B)$

$$P(A \cup B) = P(A \cap B') + P(A \cap B) + P(A' \cap B)$$

$$= P(A) + P(A' \cap B)$$

$$= P(A) + [P(B) - P(A \cap B)]$$

$$= P(A) + P(B) - P(A \cap B)$$

Other Propositions

$$A \subseteq B \implies P(A) \leq P(B)$$

$$B = (A \cap B) \cup (A' \cap B)$$

$$A \cap B = A$$

$$B = A \cup (A' \cap B)$$

$$P(B) = P(A) + P(A' \cap B) \quad (\text{by axiom 3})$$

$$P(B) \geq P(A) \quad \text{since } P(A' \cap B) \geq 0 \quad (\text{by axiom 1})$$

For any A , $A \subseteq S$

$$P(A) \leq P(S)$$

$$\therefore P(A) < 1$$

Example If $P(C) = .46$, $P(D) = .47$, $P(C \cup D) = .62$, find the following:

$$P(C') = 1 - P(C) = 1 - .46 = .54$$

$$P(C \cap D) = P(C) + P(D) - P(C \cup D) = .46 + .47 - .62 = .31$$

$$P(C \cap D') = P(C) - P(C \cap D) = .46 - .31 = .15$$

$$P(C' \cup D') = 1 - P(C \cap D) = 1 - .31 = .69$$

Probability Square Trick

Example There are 5 simple events in a sample space. $S = E_1, E_2, E_3, E_4, E_5$ with probabilities p_1, p_2, p_3, p_4, p_5 . Suppose $p_3 = 2p_2 = 2p_4$ and $p_2 = 2p_1 = 2p_5$. Find p_1, p_2, p_3, p_4, p_5 .

$$p_1 + p_2 + p_3 + p_4 + p_5 = 1$$

$$p_3 = 2p_2$$

$$p_3 = 2p_4$$

$$p_4 = p_2$$

$$p_2 = 2p_1$$

$$p_2 = 2p_5$$

$$p_1 = p_5$$

Solve for the 5 unknowns with the 5 equations:

Equally Likely Outcomes

If all outcomes in a sample space are equally likely for any event A, then

$$P(A) = \frac{\text{Number of outcomes in A}}{\text{Number of outcomes in S}} = \frac{n(A)}{n(S)}$$

where $n(A)$ is the number of outcomes in event A and $n(S)$ is the number of outcomes in sample space S.

Combinatorics

Combinatorics is the branch of mathematics dealing with combinations of objects in specific sets under certain constraints. It provides tools for counting and arranging objects.

Some basic combinatorial concepts include:

- **Permutations:** The number of ways to arrange a set of objects in a specific order.
- **Combinations:** The number of ways to select a subset of objects from a larger set, without regard to the order of selection.